Roadmap

Ticked means built, tested and deployed. This is the page to keep current.

Last updated: 16 September 2026.

Phase 0 — the management system (done, running)

The shop has been using this for a while. Listed so the rest has context.

- ✓ Visits, services, customers, barbers
- ✓ Cash drawer: open, movements, close, reconcile, shift and day reports
- ✓ Payment by cash, card, **InstaPay**, or any mix of the three
- ✓ Expenses and advances, per account (cash / card / InstaPay)
- ✓ Payroll: commissions, advances, penalties, attendance
- ✓ Warehouse: purchases, suppliers, issue notes, stocktakes
- ✓ Reports and the owner's overview, discounts, activity trail
- ✓ Logins end after 2 hours, or 30 minutes idle, on shop devices

Phase 1 — booking core (done)

✓ **1a** Appointment model; opening hours, barber hours, time off, who does what; service lengths; the free-slot rules, tested including the summer clock change

✓ **1b** Appointments API and the shop's diary: book, move, arrived, no-show, cancel; booking settings screen; no double-booking, enforced on save

✓ **1c** Customer accounts by phone number; the customer app (`/app`): book, see, cancel, profile; staff and customers walled apart, with tests

Phase 2 — the till side (next)

The piece that makes booking worth having: one appointment, one visit, one set of figures.

- ○ Ring up an appointment → it becomes a `Visit`, exactly once, carrying its lines
- ○ "Arrived" and "in the chair" from the till as well as the diary
- ○ Walk-ins: add to the diary without an appointment, wait in a live queue
- ○ Live queue screen: now, next, waiting; assign a barber
- ○ Today at a glance for the owner: booked, walk-ins, completed, no-shows, takings
- ○ No-shows counted, so the shop can see the cost of them

Needs from you: a decision on whether a booked customer who does not pay at the till (walks out, pays later) should leave the appointment open or closed.

Phase 3 — keeping customers (after that)

- ○ Barber logins and their own day: schedule, their customers, their earnings
- ○ Customer notes the barber sees ("low fade, same as last time")
- ○ Barber profiles in the customer app: photo, bio, book with them
- ○ Reminders the day before, and a booking confirmation
- ○ Offers, shown in the app
- ○ Reviews after a visit

Needs from you: an SMS or WhatsApp provider (a monthly cost, plus a registered sender name), and photos and a line of bio for each barber.

Phase 4 — the phone apps

- ○ React Native (Expo) app over the same API
- ○ Push notifications instead of SMS where the app is installed
- ○ Android build, then submission to Google Play
- ○ iPhone build, then submission to the App Store

Needs from you: a Google Play account (one-off $25) and an Apple Developer account ($99 a year). The accounts must be in the shop's name, and only you can submit. I build the apps and prepare the listings.

Phase 5 — loyalty and depth

- ○ Loyalty: points or visit counts, with rules you set
- ○ Referrals and birthday offers
- ○ Deeper reports: retention, busiest times, barber utilisation, new versus returning
- ○ Customer segments for offers

Kept in mind, not scheduled

- Deposits or paying online — needs a gateway and a refund policy
- A second branch — the model allows it; nothing is built for it
- Forgot-password for customers — safest once SMS exists; until then the shop resets it

Open questions

1. **Cancellation window** is 2 hours. Right for Escape?
2. **Three bookings at once** per customer. Enough?
3. **No-show policy** — does a customer who misses twice get blocked from booking online?
4. **Service lengths** are seeded estimates (haircut 30, beard 20, protein 120). They decide how many slots a day holds, so they are worth correcting on the services screen.

How to try it

`docker compose up --build`, then http://localhost:3000. Sign in with the accounts printed in the log; the customer app is at `/app`, and you can create a customer account from there with any Egyptian mobile number.
